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Citizenship: USA, Colombia, Spain

Fields of Concentration:

Primary: Development Economics

Secondary: Industrial Organization, International Trade

Qualifying Examinations Completed:

2023 (Oral): Industrial Organization, International Trade (*with distinction*)

Dissertation Title: *Essays in Development Economics*

Committee:

Professor Nicholas Ryan (Chair)

Professor Lauren Falcao Bergquist

Professor Katja Seim

Education:

Ph.D., Economics, Yale University, 2027 (expected)

M.Phil., Economics, Yale University, 2024

M.A., Economics, Yale University, 2023

B.A., Ethics, Politics & Economics; Applied Mathematics (*cum laude*), Yale University, 2019

Fellowships, Honors and Awards:

National Science Foundation Graduate Research Fellowship, 2021 – 2026

University Fellowship, Yale University, 2021-2026

Cowles Foundation and Economic Growth Center Graduate Fellowship, 2021 – 2026

Ryoichi Sasakawa Young Leaders Fellowship Fund (Sylff) Fellow, 2024 – 2025

Les Aspin '60 Fellowship, Yale Jackson School for Global Affairs, 2017

Dwight V. V. Waterman Memorial Prize, Yale College, 2017

Research Grants:

“Quality Screening through Market Access in Public Infrastructure Procurement”

Yale Economic Growth Center Sylff Research Grant (~\$13,000 USD), 2024 and 2025

International Growth Centre (IGC) Small Research Grant (~\$26,300 USD), 2024

International Growth Centre (IGC) Full Research Grant (~\$75,000 USD), 2025

“Supply-Chain Spillovers from Public Procurement Contracts”

STEG PhD Research Grant (~\$19,000 USD), 2024

IGC Small Projects Facility (~\$5,000 USD), 2025

“Corruption and Firm Competition in Kenyan Public Procurement” (with Polycarp Oduol)

J-PAL Governance Initiative Project Development Grant (~\$10,000 USD), 2025

“Search Costs and Firm-to-Firm Linkages: Experimental Evidence from Trade Fairs” (with Jie Bai, Lauren Falcao Bergquist, Federico Huneus, and Yuhei Miyauchi)

IGC Full Research Grant (~\$54,000 USD), 2024

IGC Full Research Grant (~\$60,000 USD), 2025

Teaching Experience:

Spring 2024, Teaching Assistant to Prof. Michael Booser, Development Econometrics (MA),

Yale University

Fall 2023, Teaching Assistant to Prof. Ana Cecilia Fielier, Macroeconomics and Growth (MA), Yale University

Research and Work Experience:

Graduate Research Assistant to Prof. Lauren Falcao Bergquist, Yale University 2023-2024

Pre-Doctoral Research Fellow to Profs. Joshua Angrist and Parag Pathak, MIT 2019-2021

Associate Consultant Summer Intern, Bain & Company, 2018

Working Papers:

“Quality Screening through Market Access in Public Infrastructure Procurement”, (August 2026), *Job Market Paper*

Work In Progress:

“Supply-Chain Spillovers from Public Procurement Contracts”

“Search Costs and Firm-to-Firm Linkages: Experimental Evidence from Trade Fairs”, (with Jie Bai, Lauren Falcao Bergquist, Federico Huneus, and Yuhei Miyauchi)

Business Case Studies:

“Colombia - Work for Taxes: Post-Conflict Development of Rural Zones” (with Jaan Elias, Greg MacDonald, and Ian Shapiro), *Yale SOM Case 20-026*, March 22, 2020.

Seminar and Conference Presentations:

2026 Harvard-Yale Development PhD Workshop

8th World Bank/ODI Global/IFS Public Finance Conference (*scheduled*)

2024 Conference in Field Experiments in Strategy

Languages:

Spanish (native), English (native), French (advanced)

References:

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Dissertation Abstract

Quality Screening through Market Access in Public Infrastructure Procurement [Job Market Paper]

Public infrastructure is critical for economic development, but its delivery is often difficult to ensure. Governments frequently have limited capacity to screen firms' quality before awarding contracts and to monitor their performance afterward. They may instead screen quality indirectly by making eligibility for future contracts depend on the execution of past ones. These restrictions aim to allocate valuable contracts to firms that complete work more quickly, but they also reduce competition. I ask how well eligibility rules based on past execution screen firm quality, how much this screening raises procurement costs, and how alternative rules would perform.

I study Rwanda's procurement of public infrastructure, where firms progress through categories that determine the size of projects on which they may bid. Promotion depends partly on past completed contracts. Studying this policy presents two challenges. First, procurement records generally end at contract award and do not measure subsequent execution. Second, firms compete repeatedly, so winning affects both their current workload and their access to future contracts. Bids may therefore reflect construction costs, competition, and the value of future market access.

I address both challenges by obtaining electronic procurement records for the near-universe of public infrastructure tenders in Rwanda between 2017 and 2024. I combine these records with government payments recorded in Value-Added Tax (VAT) declarations, which allow me to measure quarterly contract completion. I find substantial heterogeneity in project execution. Only one-third of firms' project portfolios are fully paid by their scheduled completion date; while another third are delayed by more than two years. Firm characteristics explain considerably more of the variation in execution than project or buyer characteristics. Although completion speed does not enter contract award conditional on bid rank, faster firms accumulate paid experience faster and advance through the category ladder sooner.

To interpret these empirical findings and quantify mechanisms, I estimate a dynamic auction model in which firms differ in execution speed (quality), carry unfinished contracts, and accumulate the paid experience required for promotion. Winning adds backlog, which may increase costs, but completing the work expands future project eligibility. The model separates construction costs, markups due to limited competition, and the continuation value of winning.

I find significant differences in project completion speed: high-quality firms clear 39 percent of their outstanding work per quarter, compared with 17 percent for low-quality firms. High-quality firms value awards more because completing them expands their future eligibility sooner; removing this continuation value would reduce their share of awards by 10 percent. This screening comes at the cost of thinner competition for the largest projects. Allowing firms one category below a tender's requirement to bid when they satisfy the next category's turnover threshold reduces expected total procurement costs by 1.4 percent without increasing expected delay. Counterfactuals evaluate the extent to which use of firms' types directly at the contract award stage could improve procurement outcomes.

Supply-Chain Spillovers from Public Procurement Contracts

Public procurement contracts may constitute large, project-specific demand shocks to winning firms and their suppliers. Do these shocks leave lasting changes in firms and domestic supply chains, or do their effects fade when projects end? I study this question using public infrastructure projects in Rwanda, linking administrative e-procurement records to firm tax returns and firm-to-firm VAT records. A matched design comparing winners with narrowly unsuccessful bidders yields two sets of findings. First, winning sharply raises government sales during project execution, but the effects fade after the contract period. Second, procurement reorganizes sourcing around the project site. During execution, winning nearly triples the probability of forming a relationship with an available supplier in the project district—from 0.92 to 2.50 percent—and increases the firm-level number of new project-district suppliers by approximately 14 percent. This sourcing shift persists beyond the scheduled contract end: during the 3-6 months afterwards, winners remain 15 percentage points more likely than close runners-up to purchase from a project-district supplier. However, by 9-12 months afterwards, the gap narrows and becomes imprecise.

Search Costs and Firm-to-Firm Linkages: Experimental Evidence from Trade Fairs (with Jie Bai, Lauren Falcao Bergquist, Federico Huneeus, and Yuhei Miyauchi)

Connections between firms are critical for economic growth, providing new business, opportunities for learning by doing, and access to higher-quality inputs. What prevents firms from forming these connections? One possibility is information frictions. Industrial trade fairs are a long-standing solution to such frictions, coordinating a centralized meeting point for buyers and suppliers. In partnership with the largest operator of industrial fairs in Chile, we run a two-sided randomized controlled trial at the country's largest trade fairs in aquaculture and mining. On the supplier side, we subsidize randomly selected firms to host a booth at the fair; on the buyer side, we introduce randomly selected buyers to suppliers in randomized business meetings. This two-sided randomization distinguishes whether new connections crowd out incumbent suppliers or represent new aggregate business. Combining the experimental variation with detailed administrative tax data and firm surveys, we trace the direct effects on participants and the indirect effects on their competitors and trading partners. To assess the aggregate value of these new linkages, we build a structural model of firm-to-firm matching.